

Optical Storage

The Story of Storing

Initially, we used the floppy disk to carry home every important presentation, office document, etc, that was left pending at the end of the day. It held just 1.44 MB of data and stopped working randomly after a few rounds of usage. Then came the CDs that stored more data and were reliable too. With CD-Writers getting cheap, CDs just about replaced floppy disks as portable media.

However, a few years down the line, storage companies were at it again as they tried to break through the 700 MB limit. And along came the DVD. Today, CDs and DVDs are treading the path of co-existence. So, we have combo-drives that cater to both. The ones currently available read and write both, CDs as well as DVDs.

So, what started as a mere 1.44 MB has now reached 4.7 GB and this is not the end. Some models, such as those from Lite-On, are dual-layer DVD-

Writers. This writer, when used with the correct media, write twice the amount of data that's normally written to a DVD. Thus you will be in a position to store hundreds of MP3s and movies on a single disc. For the business user, it translates to approximately 10 CDs worth of backup on a single disc.

Speeds have increased too. From a slow read speed of 1X to 52X for CD-ROM and 16X for DVD-ROM, it's been taking significant strides. The same is true for the write speed of CD and DVD-Writers—what took half an hour to burn can now be accomplished in under three minutes.

External drives is another interesting category meant for laptop users and people on the move. Their initial installments were heavy and bulky, but design improvements have made them light and slim, hence carrying them around is not a problem any more.

8 easy steps to burn that perfect CD

- Turn the screensaver off while burning a CD, so that it does not hamper the flow of data to the CD-Writer.
- Defragment the hard disk before burning a CD.
- If you have a speedy CD-Writer but a slow processor and hard disk subsystem (ATA 33), it's safer to burn the CD at a speed lower than the maximum possible.
- Use 'Track At Once' instead of 'Disk At Once' to burn an Audio CD. This makes the Audio CD look more professional since a 2-second gap is inserted between each burned track and the CD can then be mass produced error-free.
- Always 'finalise' a burned Audio CD to ensure that it plays on your home music system.
- Use branded CDs to burn critical data—cheaper media are prone to damage and do not hold data for long. Moreover, there's no guarantee that they will burn everything perfectly.
- Shut down all other applications while burning CDs. Avoid using the PC for any other tasks while a CD is burning.
- Try to simulate a burn process if the writer has just presented you with a coaster. Most CD-Writing software allow for this.



Launching First Ever
Double layer 8x DVD±RW

Presenting the New generation DVD writer featuring **DOUBLE LAYER** writing capacity on one side of DVD (8.5 GB capacity compared to 4.7GB capacity of current DVD writers)

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All Lite-On writers are available in Black colour also